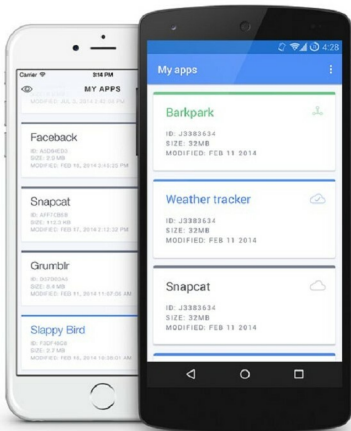


Ionic: A UI Framework to Simplify Hybrid Mobile App Development

This article presents Ionic, which is a framework for hybrid mobile app development. Hybrid apps have all the advantages of native apps and mobile websites combined within them. Ionic makes the task of creating hybrid apps very easy, and these can be ported to various platforms.



With prolific growth in the number and variety of smartphone applications, which span multiple platforms, it becomes mandatory to increase the speed of app development to stay competitive in the market. Ionic is a promising open source mobile UI framework that makes the hybrid app development process swifter and smoother.

Smartphone apps have become an inevitable part of our day-to-day life. A recent study has found that around 52 per cent of time spent on the digital media is with smartphone apps, which clearly indicates the central role that mobile apps have attained in the recent past. The estimated revenue generated through smartphone apps is a massive US\$ 45 billion. The aforementioned statistics loudly proclaim the need to focus more on smartphone application development in terms of speed and cross-platform support. Mobile apps can be categorised into three broad categories:

- Native apps
- Mobile websites
- Hybrid apps

Each of the above categories has its own pros and cons. Native apps are tightly integrated with the platform for which they are built. Obviously, the major issue with native apps is the need for a separate development process for individual platforms like Android, iOS, etc. So native app development requires specialised development teams.

The mobile websites, on the other hand, are completely developed with Web technologies like HTML 5, CSS 3, etc, and run on a smartphone Web browser. They are primarily mobile extensions of the websites. Mobile websites are not able to harness the full potential of the platform and the hardware sensors.

Hybrid apps are built by merging the advantages of both the above categories. These apps enable developers to use the same code base and export it to different platforms,